Sergio Márquez

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Senior Product Engineer | Ruby on Rails | SaaS, APIs & Full-Stack Web Platforms

Summary

Code-first Senior Product Engineer building software professionally since 2011, primarily with Ruby on Rails, across SaaS, education technology, and mobile products. Combines product discovery, systems design, and full-stack delivery. Built a microschool management platform from scratch in a four-developer team; previously owned architecture and technical planning within a team of six engineers, reduced page-load times by 20% to 80%, and modernized more than 500,000 lines of legacy Rails code.

Work Experience

Senior Product Engineer (Ruby on Rails), Contract May 2024 — Present
KaiPod Learning (Y Combinator S21) *Boston, MA / Remote*

- Build Newton, a Ruby on Rails platform with Hotwire Native mobile applications for KaiPod's Partner Network of 150+ schools across 30+ states, as part of a four-developer team.
- Lead product discovery from stakeholder interviews through approved implementation plans, using Claude and Pencil for research and mockups and Linear for project documentation, task breakdowns, and estimates.
- Expanded Newton's Action Cable messaging with announcements, search, reactions, read receipts, and threaded conversations; improved performance through query optimization and layered caching.
- Implement role-based workflows for school owners, staff, teachers, parents, and students across web and mobile experiences.
- Implement native controls and widgets for Hotwire Native on iOS and Android, including bottom navigation, dialogs, sidebar menus, and page transitions.
- Implemented Stripe APIs and webhooks for recurring monthly billing and customizable per-student plans.

Lead Software Engineer Aug 2021 — May 2024
Decisiv, Inc. *Glen Allen, VA / Remote*

- Owned architecture and technical planning for the Pricing application within a team of six engineers; mentored junior engineers and approved most pull requests.
- Reduced page-load times by 20% to 80% for complex workflows through N+1 elimination, bounded queries, lighter JavaScript, and asynchronously loaded React widgets.
- Cut CircleCI workflow time from approximately 40 minutes to 8 minutes by modernizing the test suite, updating Capybara, removing redundant specs, and parallelizing execution.
- Championed incremental upgrades of 500,000+ lines from Rails 4.0/Ruby 1.8 to Rails 7.0/Ruby 3.1 using next_rails, tests for each target version, and smoke testing.

Ruby on Rails Engineer Jul 2017 — Aug 2021
Decisiv, Inc. *Glen Allen, VA / Remote*

- Redesigned and rebuilt several Ruby on Rails product applications and integrated third-party systems with Decisiv's core platform, improving API performance and interoperability.

Ruby on Rails Engineer, Full-time May 2016 — May 2017
Paper Kite Ltd (PaperKite) *Wellington, New Zealand / On-site*

- Developed resilient Ruby on Rails APIs for BPme, a mobile in-car fuel payment app handling high traffic and external payment service integration.
- Supported BPme's staged Jul 2016 rollout with sub-second system response for site-status checks and pump authorization across 100+ designed screens.

Education

Universidad Tecnológica Nacional Mar del Plata, Argentina
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science *Jul 2009 — Dec 2014*

Skills

- **Languages & Frameworks:** Ruby, Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, React, Hotwire, Hotwire Native, Tailwind CSS
- **Backend & Cloud:** PostgreSQL, Redis, Sidekiq, AWS, Stripe, API development
- **Testing & Delivery:** RSpec, test-driven development, CI/CD, Capybara, CircleCI, Datadog, performance optimization
- **Product & Process:** Product discovery, user research, systems design, technical planning, Linear
- **AI-Assisted Development:** Anthropic Claude, GitHub Copilot

Languages

Spanish: Native | English: Full professional proficiency